

hcs-web Development Report

Git history analysis - Heron Construction Services website (CappyTech/hcs-web)

Prepared 15 July 2026 | 198 commits | 12 Feb - 7 Jul 2026 | Contributors: Nuggie24 (167), CappyTech (31)

1. Executive Summary

The hcs-web repository is an Express/EJS website styled with Tailwind CSS v4 for Heron Construction Services. Development began 12 February 2026 and ramped steadily to a peak of 74 commits in May, before tapering into shorter, less frequent polish sessions through June and July. The heavy build-out phase is complete; current work centres on replacing Tailwind Plus template boilerplate with real business content and enforcing brand consistency (the maroon primary colour #8B2332).

At the current pace of roughly one focused session every one to three weeks, each clearing about one page of remaining placeholder content, the site is an estimated **2.5 to 4 months from launch-ready (mid-September to mid-November 2026)**. Batching content collection - real project photography, testimonials and link destinations - could compress this to 3-4 weeks.

2. Activity Trend

Month	Commits	Phase
Feb 2026	6	Project setup
Mar 2026	32	Initial build-out
Apr 2026	47	Build-out continues
May 2026	74	Peak activity
Jun 2026	34	Services feature + refinement
Jul 2026	5	Polish (one session, 7 Jul)

Division of labour is consistent: **Nuggie24** (167 commits) handles templates and CSS; **CappyTech** (31 commits) handles backend structure (routes, controllers, services) and dependencies, with no commits since 11 June. The most-churned files are the compiled styles.css (64 commits), home.ejs (36) and services.ejs (21). Nearly half of all commits are Tailwind CSS rebuilds - the compiled output is committed directly alongside template edits.

3. Work Completed, by Theme (Jun-Jul 2026)

Services section built out (10-18 Jun)

The largest structural change. CappyTech created the services architecture: new serviceController.js, serviceRoutes.js and serviceService.js, renamed routes/index.js to pageRoutes.js, and wired everything into app.js. On the front end, a fencing service page (~176 lines) was built up across several commits, services.ejs gained a four-step 'Our Process' section, and a category browse page was added. A Knowsley Council logo was added for the 'trusted by' strip alongside Plus Dane.

Homepage overhaul (10 Jun - 7 Jul)

home.ejs was cut by roughly 600 net lines: the boilerplate FAQ, fake testimonial grid and demo content were removed; a proper split hero was added ('Improving Properties, One Project at a Time') with CTAs; the image carousel was moved to its own section with valid responsive heights; and layout wrappers became semantic section tags.

Brand consistency and polish (23 Jun - 7 Jul)

Default Tailwind indigo colours were replaced with the brand primary maroon on CTAs, links and headings; the header was compacted (smaller logo, tighter spacing); the About page lost its fake 'world's most innovative teams' logo cloud; and the client logo strip was rebuilt as a centred flex row.

CSS churn - a caution

styles.css is compiled Tailwind output committed directly, causing wild swings (+3,980 then -4,066 lines). One bad rebuild (01955e4, 23 Jun) gutted the stylesheet almost entirely; it was not restored until 88a4419 two days later, leaving the deployed CSS effectively broken in between. The latest build also contains a likely typo: `hover:text-primary/800` (800% opacity) where `/80` was almost certainly intended.

4. Commit Log - Active Period (38 commits)

10 June - Homepage cleanup and client logos (Nuggie24)

8afa622/64b4c04 CSS rebuilds: removed 341 unused lines, then a leftover indigo-400 variable.
aef2b7e CSS rebuild (+134) for the upcoming logo section.
029a3ca Added Knowsley Council logo image (68 KB webp).
8e9a182 Removed boilerplate FAQ section (-150 lines); fixed 'Tarmacking' typo.
9dce9f1 Resized Plus Dane / Knowsley Council logos in the trust strip.
80c9574 CSS rebuild for the new logo classes.

11 June - Services structure and fencing page begins

3d2b621 CSS rebuild (~70 utilities adjusted). [Nuggie24]
42fa5cb Created browse.ejs from a raw Tailwind Plus e-commerce template (in a typo'd folder). [Nuggie24]
681c894 Wired 'Browse all categories' link from # to the browse page. [Nuggie24]
1f64699 CSS rebuild removing 122 stale lines. [CappyTech]
8c0d577/2d6c3fd Upgraded concurrently v9 to v10; regenerated lockfile. [CappyTech]
da45483 Key architectural commit: serviceController/Routes/Service created; routes/index.js renamed to pageRoutes.js; folder typo fixed. [CappyTech]
eb0ac55 'Do work': removed now-duplicate servicesByCategory handler/route/view-model from page layer. [CappyTech]
eb20205 CSS rebuild (+122). [Nuggie24]
f51cf99 First fencing.ejs content - Tailwind Plus product-page template as starting point. [Nuggie24]

16-19 June - Fencing page takes shape (Nuggie24)

4ab163c Replaced pasted e-commerce template with leaner custom layout (-234 net); touched head.ejs.
79f1755 Added Project Gallery section with fencing type cards (placeholder images).
d6700ee Added four-step 'Our Process' section to services.ejs.
dca1104 Added fencing-specific 'Our Fencing Process' section, replacing 'Fine Details'.
0f7b9f7/251f33e CSS rebuilds syncing with template edits.
d210c38 Merge of remote main - routine sync between contributors.

23-25 June - Homepage overhaul and header polish (Nuggie24)

1cbd193 CSS rebuild (-128 stale lines).
c0670da Removed fake testimonial grid with lorem ipsum (-320/+96); semantic section tags.
62f46c7 CSS rebuild (+174) for reworked homepage.
8e128f9/55be46a Header compacted: padding removed, logo shrunk per breakpoint, negative margins.
90f7a06 New split hero with headline and CTAs; carousel moved below with valid responsive heights.
01955e4 Bad CSS rebuild - wiped 4,066 lines, leaving stylesheet nearly empty.
82a4739 One-line Tailwind version banner change.
88a4419 Restorative rebuild (+3,980) fixing the gutted stylesheet two days later.
652468e Hero image swapped from Tailwind demo screenshot to placeholder.co placeholder.

7 July - Latest session (Nuggie24)

23e6357 CSS rebuild (-146 unused lines).
0107f0c Merge of remote main (June homepage/header work).
8bcfcfa Brand pass on home.ejs: indigo to primary maroon; logo strip to centred flex row; slider transition classes tweaked (some appear undefined).
6e79ada About page: removed fake 'innovative teams' logo cloud and decorative SVG.

5. Readiness Estimate

Remaining work. Templates still contain ~50 placeholder images (placeholder.co and Tailwind demo assets) and ~40 dead href="#" links across seven pages: home, about, services, fencing, browse, studies and the footer. Five files retain lorem-ipsum or demo text. browse.ejs and studies.ejs are still unconverted raw templates. That is roughly 6-7 page-sized units of work.

Pace. One focused session every 1-3 weeks, each completing about one page or section. Six to seven remaining units at one per ~2 weeks puts completion 12-14 weeks out: **mid-September to mid-November 2026.**

The real bottleneck is assets, not code. Most placeholders need genuine photos of completed fencing, driveway and construction work, plus real testimonials. Template editing is fast; gathering photography is the piece that could stretch - or, if photos already exist, dramatically compress - the timeline.

How to beat the estimate

- Batch content collection: gather all photos, testimonial quotes and link destinations in one go.
- Trim launch scope: cutting studies.ejs and browse.ejs removes about a third of remaining placeholders.
- A minimum viable launch (home, about, services, fencing, contact, working footer) is ~3 sessions of template work once assets are in hand - roughly 3-4 weeks.

6. Recommendations

- Stop committing compiled styles.css; commit the Tailwind source and build on deploy. This removes half the commit noise and prevents another broken-CSS window like 23-25 June.
- Fix the hover:text-primary/800 typo (should almost certainly be /80).
- Verify the 'soft cinematic fade-in-out' classes on the testimonial slider are actually defined.
- Check the duplicate views/home.ejs vs views/pages/home.ejs - deleting the abandoned one removes 9 placeholders and 5 dead links for free.
- Rename the 'services by category' folder to avoid spaces in paths.